

## Protect AI launches open source solutions for AI/ML security



Protect AI, known for its AI and machine learning (ML) security expertise, has introduced three open source software (OSS) tools—NB Defense, ModelScan, and Rebuff. The aim is to address the pressing need for security in the AI/ML field.

Amidst the proliferation of AI and ML tools, security has been a growing concern, and Protect AI aims to provide practical solutions. CEO Ian Swanson stated, “Our goal is to raise awareness for the need to make AI safer and provide tools organisations can start using immediately to protect their AI/ML applications.”

NB Defense is a tool that scans Jupyter Notebooks—a key platform for data scientists. It detects leaked credentials, PII (personally identifiable information) disclosure, licensing issues, and security vulnerabilities within these documents.

ModelScan ensures the security of ML models shared online. It scans for unsafe code, safeguarding users who work with popular ML frameworks like PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, Sklearn, and XGBoost.

Protect AI’s Rebuff addresses security concerns in large language models (LLMs). Vulnerable to prompt injection (PI) attacks, Rebuff offers a self-hardening prompt injection detection framework with four layers of defence.

These tools can be used as standalone solutions or integrated into the Protect AI platform, providing visibility, audibility, and enhanced security for ML systems.

### Malicious npm package deploys rootkit

A malicious npm package that deploys an open source rootkit has raised concerns within the cybersecurity community. It marks a disconcerting trend, as it is the first known instance of a rogue package delivering rootkit functionality.

The malicious package, named ‘node-hide-console-windows’, cleverly mimics the legitimate npm package ‘node-hide-console-window’, exploiting minor typographical errors in what’s known as typosquatting. Alarming, this fraudulent package amassed 704 downloads over two months before being removed from the npm registry.

The discovery was made by ReversingLabs, a software supply chain security firm, which first detected these activities in August 2023. According to ReversingLabs, the package facilitated the download of a Discord bot, which,

### RISC-V warns export controls may stifle tech innovation

The chief executive of RISC-V International, Calista Redmond, has voiced concerns over potential US government restrictions on open source technology that could hamper chip development, impacting the global tech industry.

US lawmakers are urging the Biden administration to impose export control restrictions on RISC-V, an open source technology managed by RISC-V International. This technology is vital for creating chips in smartphones and AI.

RISC-V has found favour not only with major US firms like Qualcomm and Google but also with Chinese giant Huawei, raising national security concerns. Redmond defended RISC-V, comparing it to other open technology standards like Ethernet, which enables internet-connected computers to communicate.

Redmond warned that unprecedented restrictions on open standards might limit access to global markets, slowing product and talent flow. She cautioned against bifurcation at the standards level, which could lead to incompatible solutions and market closures.

Crucially, Redmond stressed that RISC-V has global contributions, from North America, Europe, and Asia. The standards published by RISC-V International do not offer a complete chip blueprint or proprietary information. The key difference lies in the freedom to use these open standards without requiring proprietary licences.

Redmond said, “Having access to open standards allows companies to innovate faster and spend their time creating differentiated products, rather than trying to reinvent the wheel.”